

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Appointments and Time Expressions**

Sections covered: TAB: 25. Nicos Weg - Lerngewohnheiten vocabulary (weiter-, abfahren, Neuanfang, schaffen, üben, lügen, reflexive verbs), TAB: 27. Speaking - Appointment making with time expressions (ab, von...bis, vor) and um...zu constructions

LESSON SUMMARY

Kevin and Stefanie discussed transitioning from Preply to Google Meet or Microsoft Teams, with Kevin recommending Google Meet for better quality. They reviewed vocabulary from Nicos Weg, focusing on continuation words (weiter-), departure verbs (abfahren, weggehen), and the phrase "Wir schaffen das" (Angela Merkel's refugee slogan). Key grammar covered reflexive pronouns with body parts (dative: Ich wasche mir die Hände), direct vs. indirect lying (lügen vs. belügen), and schauen vs. anschauen. The main speaking exercise practiced making appointments using time expressions (ab, von...bis, vor) and giving reasons with weil and um...zu constructions.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **die Hymne** — anthem [A2]
- **weiterstudieren** — continue studying [B1]
- **weitergehen** — go on, continue [A2]
- **weggehen** — go away [A2]
- **abfahren** — depart [A2]
- **der Neuanfang** — new beginning [B1]
- **der Anfang** — beginning [A2]
- **anfangen** — start, begin [A2]
- **beginnen** — begin [A2]
- **schaffen** — make it, manage [B1]
- **üben** — practice [A2]
- **der Erfolg** — success [A2]
- **lügen** — lie [B1]
- **belügen** — lie to someone [B1]
- **anlügen** — lie to someone [B1]
- **anschauen** — look at [A2]
- **schauen** — look [A2]
- **die Runde** — round [A2]
- **duschen** — shower [A1]
- **waschen** — wash [A1]
- **der Kühlschrank** — refrigerator [A2]
- **ab** — from (time onwards) [A2]

- **genug** — enough [A2]
- **genügend** — sufficient [B1]
- **vor** — before [A2]
- **treffen** — meet [A2]
- **das Geschenk** — gift [A2]
- **alleine** — alone [A2]
- **danach** — afterwards [A2]
- **dann** — then [A1]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Reflexive pronouns with body parts use dative

→ When washing body parts, German uses dative reflexive pronouns because the body part is the direct object (accusative). You cannot have two accusatives in one sentence, so the reflexive pronoun becomes dative. Example: 'Ich wasche mir die Hände' (I wash my hands to myself) - 'mir' is dative, 'die Hände' is accusative.

e.g. Ich wasche mir die Hände. (I wash my hands - 'mir' dative, 'die Hände' accusative)

e.g. Du putzt dir die Zähne. (You brush your teeth - 'dir' dative, 'die Zähne' accusative)

lügen vs. belügen/anlügen - direct object changes verb

→ The verb 'lügen' (to lie) is intransitive and cannot take a direct object. However, 'belügen' and 'anlügen' are transitive with the prefix making the person a direct accusative object. The prefix 'be-' transforms intransitive verbs to transitive verbs that take accusative objects directly.

e.g. Ich lüge. (I lie - no object, intransitive)

e.g. Ich belüge dich. (I lie to you - accusative direct object)

schauen vs. anschauen - with/without object

→ The verb 'schauen' means 'to look' without requiring a specific object (intransitive). When you want to 'look at' something specific, use 'anschauen' with the accusative object. The reflexive 'sich anschauen' (dative reflexive) emphasizes you're watching/looking at something for yourself.

e.g. Schau! (Look! - no object, imperative)

e.g. Ich schaue aus dem Fenster. (I look out the window - direction, no direct object)

Time expressions: ab, von...bis, vor

→ 'ab' means 'from (time) onwards' with open end time (starting point). 'von...bis' means 'from...to' with specific start and end times (bounded period). 'vor' means 'before' a specific time or 'ago' (past reference). 'nach' means 'after'. These prepositions structure appointments and schedules with different cases.

e.g. Ab sieben Uhr habe ich Zeit. (From 7 o'clock onwards I have time - open ended)

e.g. Von sieben bis acht Uhr. (From 7 to 8 o'clock - specific bounded period)

um...zu infinitive construction for purpose

→ The construction 'um...zu + infinitive' expresses purpose or intention (in order to do something). Place 'um' after the comma before the infinitive clause, and 'zu' comes directly before the infinitive at the end of the clause. This construction requires the same subject in both clauses.

e.g. Ich gehe in die Stadt, um ein Geschenk zu kaufen. (I go to the city to buy a gift)

e.g. Er lernt Deutsch, um in Deutschland zu arbeiten. (He learns German to work in Germany)

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Wir schaffen das!** — We will make it! (Angela Merkel's political slogan during the 2014-2015 refugee crisis. Used to express confidence in managing difficult tasks.)
- **Viel Erfolg!** — Good luck! (Much success!) (Common expression wishing someone success in an endeavor)
- **Ich nehme mir Zeit.** — I take my time. (Reflexive expression emphasizing doing something for oneself at one's own pace)
- **Ich mache eine Runde.** — I go for a round/walk. (Casual expression for taking a walk or doing a circuit)
- **fürs Erste** — for the first thing, for now (fürs = für das; used to indicate initial priority or temporary measure)
- **Hast du Zeit?** — Do you have time? (Standard question when arranging meetings or appointments)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Reflexive pronouns with body parts use dative).

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Reflexive pronouns with body parts use dative. Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence